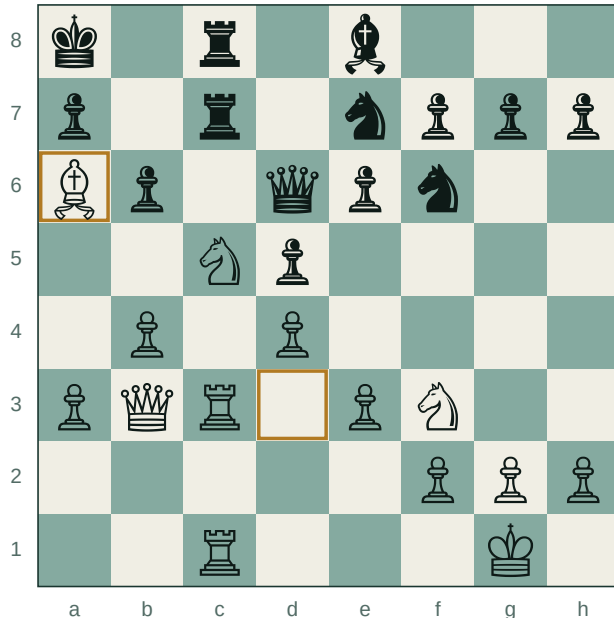


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 19

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 19.Ba6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19...bxc5 20. Bxc8 c4

19...bxc5 The pawn captures the knight on c5. The changed line means the queen on d6 attacks the bishop on a6.
Recorded reply: **20.Bxc8**.

20...c4 The pawn moves from c5 to c4.

At the end, nominal material is White 32 / Black 30 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -2: the balance goes from +0 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.